

Los Angeles — Market Strategy Dossier

Prepared for: Jim DesRoches, Principal — KOR Structural · **Compiled** 2026-06-26 · **INTERNAL** **Companion to:** the six firm dossiers in this packet (referenced here as demand-side context, not re-profiled).

The play, in one line: LA is a **patient 2027+ build**, not near-term SD-style revenue — entered through **two doors**: (1) the **owner-direct NDC seismic-retrofit lane** (no architect gate; ~1,400 buildings in their compliance window, a ~2028 plan-deadline cliff, \$100–400K/building — KOR’s ASCE-41/PBSD depth fits and **Markulin holds the CA SE**, so licensure isn’t the gate, *presence* is); and (2) **riding KOR’s Vancouver relationships** — re-engage **Onni** (KOR has prior Onni LA work; Glotman Simpson holds the current seats but is capacity-locked) and **displace Englekirk/WSP** boutique accounts in the closing 2026 window.

Confidence-tagged throughout: [C] Confirmed · [P] Probable · [U] Unverified — do not cite [U] client-facing without confirmation.

Executive Summary (Bottom Line Up Front)

Los Angeles is the largest US construction market KOR does not yet meaningfully occupy — and the one where KOR’s identity is most structurally transferable. Four structural demand vectors converge in 2026–27: (1) a multifamily pipeline surge (15,735 units permitted in the 12 months to March 2026, +85% YoY, with Q1 2026 construction starts at a 3-year high), driven by SB 79 and developer catch-up; (2) a live, underserved NDC seismic-retrofit market with ~1,500 covered buildings in their Year-3-to-Year-10 compliance window and fees of \$100–400K/building, where only ~6% have been retrofitted; (3) a Palisades/Eaton wildfire rebuild demand surge (14,834 units damaged/destroyed, all requiring full structural engineering under 2022 CBC, representing an estimated \$150–300M in SE fees over 3–5 years); and (4) post-acquisition drift at Englekirk/WSP opening the boutique mid-market seismic developer lane in the 2026–2027 window. KOR’s most actionable near-term entry is owner-direct NDC retrofit (no architect gate; principal-led SE earns the relationship), followed by riding Vancouver developer and architect relationships into open project seats. The constraint is LA market presence and brand, not licensure — Markulin holds the CA SE.

1. Market Structure & Segmentation

1.1 Overall LA Construction Economy [C]

- California is the largest construction economy in North America: ~\$31B/yr private nonresidential + ~\$55B/yr state/local put-in-place (US Census/AGC 2024). LA County represents ~35–40% of CA volume.
- Construction cost spike: Q1 2025 saw hard costs spike 6% — the steepest quarterly rise in over a decade; 10.5% year-over-year growth by early 2025. Lumber and some steel inputs retreated from 2022–23 peaks; contractor availability improving entering 2026.
- FIFA World Cup 2026 and 2028 Summer Olympics (“no build” strategy using existing venues) are generating hospitality and LAX (\$14B upgrade) demand, but **not major structural new-build opportunity for KOR**. [C — Dodge; smartcitiesdive.com]

1.2 Residential High-Rise / Concrete High-Rise [C]

Signal	Data
Multifamily units permitted, 12 mo. ending March 2026	15,735 (+85% YoY) — #1 US metro by volume
Construction pipeline, start of 2025	26,000+ units
Projected 2026 deliveries	~6,200 units (tailing off from peak)
Q1 2026 construction starts	4,000+ units — strongest quarter since Q4 2022
Active high-rise submarkets	DTLA, South Bay, Palms/Mar Vista, Mid-Wilshire, Koreatown

Named high-rise pipeline (verified, 2025–2026):

- 1000 S. Hill Street (Onni)** — 54-story, 685 units; Arcadis AOR, Chris Dikeakos design; **topped out June 2025**, near completion. SE not publicly named. [C — Urbanize LA]
- Times Mirror Square (Onni / AC Martin)** — twin 37 + 53-story towers, 1,127 units; AC Martin is the architect of record; construction start pending. SE unconfirmed. [C — LA Downtown News]
- 1050 La Cienega (Carmel Partners / SCB)** — revised to 43-story, 532 units; Architect: Solomon Cordwell Buenz; plans refiled April 2025. [C — The Real Deal LA]

- **520 Mateo, Arts District (Carmel Partners)** — 35-story; under construction. [C — Urbanize LA]
- **Onni Arts District (2143 E. Violet)** — multiple towers; **approved June 16, 2026**. [C — Urbanize LA]
- **The BLOC Tower (700 S. Flower)** — 53-story, 710 ft (41-story tower atop existing 12-story garage); City Planning Commission approved April 2026. Would rank in LA's top 10 tallest. [C — Urbanize LA]
- **1105 S. Olive (Mack Real Estate)** — 51-story, 536 units; City Planning Commission approved. [C — Urbanize LA]
- **917–931 W. Olympic Blvd (AEG)** — 49-story, 364 units + 334-room hotel; proposed. [C — Urbanize LA]
- **2900 Wilshire (Koreatown)** — 23-story; \$300M; broke ground. [C — market research agent]
- **Cumulus District VOX (Carmel Partners)** — 7-story, 910 units; 3333 La Cienega Blvd. [C — REBusinessOnline]

Structural demand type: Concrete core high-rise (>12 story) requires PBSO / tall-building peer-review (LADBS SPRP). **This is Saiful Bouquet/TT/Arup/Englekirk/WSP territory.** KOR's LA entry lane is the 5–15 story podium and mid-rise tier — not these trophy towers (yet).

1.3 Woodframe / Podium Multifamily [C]

- The **dominant volume segment** — vast pipeline of 5-over-2 and 5-over-1 Type V/III podium across Westside, San Fernando Valley, South Bay, and TOC corridors.
- **SB 79 (effective July 2026)** creates an 85-ft by-right zoning band within transit corridors across all 8 LA County cities — a structural demand multiplier squarely in KOR's woodframe/hybrid sweet spot. [C — prior KOR research]
- KOR's dedicated CA woodframe team has limited direct comparators in SoCal — most LA SE firms run woodframe as a secondary/production line, not a specialty.
- **KOR's live LA position:** 495 Hartford/Intergulf (woodframe, active); 674 Catalina/Square Nine (active). Two real data points in this lane.
- **LA woodframe SE market is fragmented** — no firm dominates the way Saiful Bouquet dominates trophy towers. T&S Structural Engineers, JN Engineering, LFA, and numerous boutiques compete. This fragmentation is genuine opportunity. [C — SE firms research agent]

1.4 Mixed-Use [C/P]

Mixed-use (residential over retail) is the default typology for virtually all transit-adjacent LA development. SE demand is identical to podium MF. Every KTG, TCA, Steinberg Hart, and Nadel project in the pipeline is mixed-use.

1.5 Hospitality [C]

Signal	Data
LA County hotels under construction	23 hotels, 2,833 rooms
Key in-progress	Kali Hotel Autograph Collection (300 rooms, Inglewood, est. 2026); Pan Am Hotel Tapestry (145 rooms, mid-2026)
Hard cost benchmark	\$600,000/key+ for full-service new-build in LA
Demand driver	FIFA 2026 + Olympics 2028 — most consequential hospitality build in LA since 1984

SE leadership in hospitality: Saiful Bouquet (LAX Midfield, Pico+Fig, AC+Moxy with Gensler) and KPFF. Not KOR's near-term primary lane but a natural extension once LA architect relationships are built.

1.6 Life Sciences — Greater-LA [C/P]

Hub	Named project / signal
UCLA Westwood Research Park (former Westside Pavilion)	1.3M GSF, 9.2 acres — under construction March 2026; California Institute for Immunology (360,000 SF); \$700M+
Thousand Oaks (Amgen)	\$600M Center for Science & Innovation , broke ground Nov 2025 (4-story)
El Segundo	UCLA acquired 170,000 SF facility from Karney Properties (2025)
Pasadena	Biocom-backed zoning changes passed; Caltech Ginsburg Quantum Center (completion summer 2026)

SE read: Life-science new-build dominated by CO Architects (UCLA/KPFF relationship) and Perkins & Will/HED. Market in national oversupply since 2024; net new construction minimal. A watch lane for KOR (via campus-adjacent residential in Pasadena/Thousand Oaks), not a primary entry target.

1.7 Higher Education [C]

UCLA — active capital (~\$608M currently executing):

Project	Budget
Neuropsychiatric Replacement Hospital	\$352M (Oct 2026)
Gayley Towers residential redevelopment	\$118M (Feb 2027)
Mid-Wilshire Medical Office seismic improvements	\$52M (Jan 2027)
Wooden Center seismic improvements	\$47.9M (Jul 2027)
Westwood Research Park (life science)	\$700M+ site (ongoing)

The UCLA seismic improvement projects (\$100M combined) are structural-SE prime work — but through UCLA's preferred-vendor list (KPFF, Saiful Bouquet). Not KOR's entry target; useful as evidence of institutional seismic demand volume.

USC: Ginsburg Hall of Computer Science opened Sept 2024 (JAMA SE). Bloom Football Performance Center topped out April 2025. Major long-term plan: 5,400 student housing beds. JAMA is USC's de facto SE.

LAUSD: New \$9B bond approved Nov 2024 by LA voters — adds to the existing \$7B Measure RR. Sustained capital program. **DSA Field Act gate blocks KOR** until K-12 track record built.

1.8 Civic / Public [C]

Owner	Program	Scale
LA Metro	Joint Development: 10,000 homes by 2031; District NoHo (largest Metro JD in history, \$39.6M); 4 rail + 3 BRT projects all opening by 2028	~\$1.56B/yr transit capital (FY24-25)
LAUSD	\$7B Measure RR + new \$9B bond; hundreds of seismic-vulnerable buildings	Major sustained
Judicial Council	Courthouse IDIQ — next cycle ~2026–27; no DSA gate	The one accessible public SE lane for KOR
City of LA civic	Samuel Oschin Air & Space Center (\$400M, 20-story, Science Center)	Active

SE read: JAMA owns civic/aviation/institutional in LA. KPFF holds most public-sector volume. KOR's one public-sector entry = Judicial Council courthouse IDIQ (no school/hospital track record required). [C — prior CA research]

1.9 Seismic Retrofit — The Structural-Led Lane [C]

This is the highest-confidence LA SE demand opportunity for KOR in 2026. Every building requires an owner-retained licensed SE — no architect Prime gate.

Soft-Story Retrofit (Ordinance 183893):

- **Total buildings: 12,347** (LADBS official Feb 2024 Compliance Report; contractor sites round to ~13,500 — use 12,347 as the verified figure). [C — LADBS Feb 2024 report]
- **Compliance as of Feb 1, 2024:** Plans submitted 95%; permits issued 89%; **Certificate of Compliance (complete): 76% — 2,970 buildings still outstanding.** Of these: ~1,593 have permits but unfinished construction; ~1,377 have no permit.
- **All 7-year compliance deadlines have expired** (orders were mailed 2016–2017 in waves; the last 7-year clock ran out by late 2024). All 2,970 non-compliant buildings are in active enforcement — misdemeanor charges, fines, liens, vacate orders.
- **Per-building costs:** small (2–4 units) \$45–95K; medium (10–20 units) \$100–250K; large (20+ units) \$200–500K+.
- **Residual market rough estimate:** 2,970 buildings × \$100–150K average = **\$297M–\$446M** in remaining soft-story construction value. [P — my estimate; no official total]

- **SE read: commoditized, skip as primary entry.** This market is owned by vertically-integrated contractor-engineer hybrids — **Optimum Seismic (~3,500 buildings retrofitted in SoCal)**, Alpha Structural, Partner ESI — who bundle design, fabrication, and construction with SE fees as loss leaders at \$5–15K/building. A standalone SE cannot compete profitably here. Value only as a volume relationship-builder.

Non-Ductile Concrete Retrofit (Ordinance 184081):

- **Total buildings: ~1,500** (LADBS still finalizing the covered-buildings list; QuakeStrong 2024 cites 1,200+). Pre-Jan 13, 1977 concrete construction; SFH/duplex excluded. [C — LADBS; Q4 2021 Omgivning/MWest white paper]
- **Compliance as of Q4 2021** (the only public snapshot available — no 2025/2026 official update): 3-yr checklist submitted: 31%; 10-yr plans submitted: 11%; 25-yr construction complete: **3.7%**. QuakeStrong early-2024 cites ~6% construction-complete. No live LADBS dashboard exists.
- **Compliance deadlines (from order issuance, most ~Jan 2018):**
 - 3 years: Submit NDC Checklist → due ~2021 (lapsed; enforcement active)
 - **10 years: Submit retrofit plans or demolition plans → due ~2028** (the next major inflection point; building owners without SE engaged must hire now or face enforcement)
 - 25 years: Complete construction → due ~2043
- **Cost benchmarks:** Retrofit-only: \$30–50/sqft; all-in: \$50–100/sqft. A 68,000 sqft building = \$2.1M–\$6.8M.
- **Total NDC market rough estimate:** 1,400 remaining buildings × \$1M–\$4M average = **\$1.4B–\$5.6B** in structural work, running to ~2043. [P — my estimate]
- **Entry product for KOR:** A **\$15–50K Phase 1 ASCE-41 Tier 1/2 feasibility study** provides the building owner a compliance path and scoping report. This earns KOR the Year-10 design contract (\$150–400K) and a relationship the contractor-hybrids cannot replicate.
- **NDC SE competitors:** **Degenkolb** (most prominent — consults for City of LA on the ordinance program PLUS does private NDC work), **SGH** (Lane Building SEAOSC award, confirmed NDC of record), **Saiful Bouquet** (2025 SEAOSC retrofit award), **Thornton Tomasetti**, **ZFA** (self-described NDC specialist), **Structural Focus** (DTLA boutique, “hundreds” of existing buildings + nearly two dozen National Register properties). [C — SE firms research agent; seismic agent]

LA County NDC Ordinance (NEW, 2025): LA County (unincorporated areas + county-owned buildings — distinct from City of LA) introduced a high-rise NDC ordinance April 24, 2025 with a 20-year compliance window. A separate but related pool of buildings. [C — seismic research agent]

Steel Moment Frame: No mandatory SMF ordinance in the City of Los Angeles. Torrance adopted SMF requirements March 2023; LA has not followed. [C — seismic research agent]

Competitive SE fact: Degenkolb is the #1 NDC ordinance firm — they consult for the City of LA on the program design AND do private NDC work (Dignity Health, Loma Linda, multiple municipal programs). Any KOR NDC marketing must position against Degenkolb, not just LFA and Miyamoto.

1.10 Wildfire Rebuild — Palisades / Eaton (January 2025) [C]

An unplanned but immediately large SE demand event. **Every rebuild requires full structural engineering under the 2022 California Building Code** — no exemption for like-for-like replacement.

Metric	Data
Total units damaged/destroyed	14,834 housing units (13,142 parcels)
Rebuild applications received	6,116
Permits issued	2,894 (~47% of applications)
Projects under active construction	~1,420
Fully completed buildings	28 — massive backlog, 3–5 year demand runway

SE opportunity estimate: If 10,000 homes are rebuilt at average SE fee of \$15–30K each, that equals **\$150–300M in structural engineering fees** concentrated in LA’s highest-cost West Side zip codes. Miyamoto launched a dedicated “Rebuild LA” program (January 2025) and is the most visible SE firm in this lane. KOR is not positioned here yet; it would require a local Los Angeles presence and fast-track permit experience. **This is a medium-term opportunity to monitor, not an immediate entry target.** [C — CalMatters; LA City Planning; GlobeSt]

2. Competitive Landscape — Structural Engineers in LA

Ownership note: Multiple LA SE firms have undergone acquisition. **Englekirk → WSP (Oct 2021): the boutique is measurably hollowing out — ~90 employees at acquisition, confirmed ~43 by March 2026 (a 52% headcount decline).** Robert Englekirk is Chairman Emeritus; Tony Ghodsi is now an SVP inside a 65,000-person global firm. No single 2026 trigger event, but the cumulative client-drift is at its most acute *now* — the displacement window is real, not theoretical. Brandow & Johnston is now B&J HBK, Inc. (HBK Engineering, Jan 2018). **Nabih Youssef Associates: founder Nabih died July 2024; CEO is now son John Paul Youssef — a legal/business professional, NOT a structural engineer.** The four remaining Principals cover the landmark tier (unassailable 3–5 yrs), but the *personal-relationship* layer that won boutique mid-market PBSD commissions is gone — a real \$5–50M-tier opening.

2.1 Tier 1: Trophy / Supertall (NOT KOR's lane)

Firm	Scale	LA strongholds	Confirmed architect relationships	KOR note
Saiful Bouquet	~81 staff; Pasadena + LA + SD	Luxury high-rise, PBSD, healthcare, hospitality	Gensler (AC+Moxy \$250M/727-room DTLA hotel; Metropolis 39-story/Greenland Group); One Beverly Hills (\$5B, Aman-branded)	Not KOR's lane in trophy tier. Contest only in 8–15 story dev-MF where they're underweight, and in NDC retrofit. 2025 SEAOSC award winner (New Construction + Retrofit categories). [C — Saiful Bouquet website]
Thornton Tomasetti	~2,100–2,400 staff firm-wide; LA office at 707 Wilshire	Sports/supertall/forensics/blast; SoFi Stadium + Hollywood Park (3.1M SF, confirmed SE); UCLA Ostin Music Center; BMO Stadium	AC Martin (Wilshire Grand, 2017); Hanjin	No collision in KOR's developer-residential lane. [C — TT website]
Arup	Global; LA active	Mega-civic/transit (LAX, Metro Transit Center), multidisciplinary	LACMTA, LAWA	No collision in developer-residential. [C]
Nabih Youssef Associates (NYA)	Multi-office; founder Nabih died July 2024	PBSD pioneer, base isolation, landmark civic (LA City Hall, The Broad, Cathedral of Our Lady of Angels)	Getty, UCSF, LA Metro, Diller Scofidio (The Broad)	Succession risk = narrow window in seismic specialty mid-market (2027–28 horizon). Institutional anchors stay; boutique PBSD commissions loosened. KOR presence investment (SEAOSC/LATBSDC) is the prerequisite. [C — NYA; Wikipedia]

2.2 Tier 2: Civic / Institutional (NOT KOR's primary lane)

Firm	Scale	LA strongholds	Confirmed relationships	KOR displacement verdict
John A. Martin & Associates (JAMA)	400+ staff firm-wide; LA HQ since 1953; expanding (Seattle Dec 2025; acquired Martin White & Griffis AZ + Studio Engineers Santa Barbara both 2025)	Aviation (LAX Tom Bradley ITB, ENR Best 2024), K-12, healthcare, high-rise residential, civic; Natural History Museum Commons (ENR Best Dec 2025)	USC (anchor — 30+ projects: Ginsburg Hall, Bloom Football Center, Village, Wallis Annenberg, etc.), LAUSD, Kaiser, Caltrans	Not KOR's lane in civic/institutional. Contest zone: private-sector developer MF where JAMA's public DNA is a mismatch. JAMA is expanding — may crowd into more developer-residential work. Monitor. [C — JAMA website; prior research]

Firm	Scale	LA strongholds	Confirmed relationships	KOR displacement verdict
KPFF (GLAS)	~1,400 firm-wide; LA since 1967/68; Irvine satellite	Broad generalist: civic, healthcare, stadiums, education, civil infrastructure	Providence Cedars-Sinai (healthcare); LACCD; Destination Crenshaw (Metro arts)	#1 statewide firm to beat — only the mid-market podium developer tier below their large-project threshold is contestable. [C — KPFF website; prior research]
Degenkolb Engineers	~433 staff (Dec 2025, growing 10%/yr); LA DTLA office	Seismic retrofit — existing buildings; City of LA mandatory programs; hospital compliance (SB 1953)	City of LA (NDC + soft-story programs); Dignity Health; Loma Linda University; City of Santa Monica/Pasadena/West Hollywood seismic programs	Most important NDC competitor. Degenkolb is embedded in the City's seismic programs — they know the program from the inside. Any KOR NDC case must be differentiated vs Degenkolb specifically. [C — Degenkolb website; seismic agent]

2.3 Tier 3: Developer Mid-Market (KOR's primary competition tier)

Firm	Scale	LA strongholds	Confirmed architect/developer relationships	KOR strategic read
Englekirk / WSP	~105 staff, 51 engineers (post-WSP); acquired Oct 2021	Developer residential high-rise, hotel, mixed-use, multifamily, adaptive reuse; CSU systemwide peer review	Gensler (Google Westside Pavilion/Hudson Pacific); Mitsui Fudosan (Figueroa Eight, 41-story); TCA Architects (Jefferson Inglewood, 8-story 222u)	#1 displacement target in mid-market developer MF. WSP corporate overhead replaces boutique responsiveness; developer clients who chose Englekirk for principal access now face a \$11B global firm's procurement layer. Carmel Partners, Jamison, Related CA, MVE = loosened accounts. Window = 2026 is the last high-quality displacement year before re-equilibration. [C — WSP press release; SE firms agent]
DCI Engineers	~350 firm-wide; LA satellite office (~8 named staff)	High-rise/podium/modular/hospitality; mass timber	Frank Gehry (The Grand LA, Related, 46-story, 2022 ACI SoCal Award); Olson Kundig (8899 Beverly, 9-story luxury 40u, AIA LA award)	Small LA satellite — thin on local developer relationships. Won on design-architect relationships (Gehry, Olson Kundig). KOR's edge: principal engagement + local seismic credibility. Contest TCA's non-modular LA projects. [C — DCI website]

Firm	Scale	LA strongholds	Confirmed architect/developer relationships	KOR strategic read
Labib Funk + Associates (LFA)	80+ engineers ; Glendale HQ; structural + shoring + civil in-house	Mixed-use MF (woodframe + podium + concrete), sports/entertainment (Intuit Dome as assoc. SE, SoFi Stadium, Lakers/Clippers facilities), adaptive reuse, seismic retrofit	AECOM/Anderson Barker (Intuit Dome); Lorcan O’Herlihy Architects (1500 Granville, AIA LA award, WoodWorks award); Withee Malcolm; West Edge developer (AIA CA Design Award 2024, PCBC Gold Nugget 2024)	KOR’s closest LA analog — and largest direct competitor. 80+ engineers vs KOR’s much smaller LA team; shoring/civil in-house adds value on tight urban sites. Their West Edge (creative office + 600 resi) and 1500 Granville (woodframe, AIA + WoodWorks awards) are directly in KOR’s typology. KOR’s edge: Vancouver seismic heritage, PBSO depth, Canadian developer relationships (Onni). [C — LFA website; awards]
SGH (Simpson Gumpertz & Heger)	700+ nationally; LA at 757 S. Alameda + Newport Beach	NDC seismic retrofit, forensic/investigation, historic preservation, building enclosures	Omgivning Architects (Lane Building: 12-story NDC concrete → retail + 100+ resi units; SEAOSC Excellence Award); City of LA seismic programs	Direct NDC lane competitor — the Lane Building win is the proof-of-concept KOR is chasing. Omgivning is a leading DTLA adaptive-reuse architect: SGH → Omgivning is the incumbent pairing to displace in the office-to-residential conversion lane. [C — SGH website; SEAOSC award]
Brandow & Johnston / B&J HBK	Acquired by HBK Engineering Jan 2018; operating under B&J HBK brand	Seismic retrofit, historic preservation, SoCal high-rise (Wilshire Grand legacy), tall buildings	AC Martin (Wilshire Grand, 73-story, 1,100 ft — legacy credential); USC (30+ projects: Heritage Hall, Fertitta, Doheny Eye Hospital); KFA (Strubb Hall historic/seismic)	Post-HBK acquisition, brand perception in the mid-market shifting. KOR’s BIM-native fresh alternative pitch applies. Note: B&J has the KFA relationship — the same architect as KOR’s Fox Hills target. [C — bjsce.com]
Miyamoto International	1,000–5,000 globally; LA at 707 Wilshire	Seismic retrofit, historic preservation (Hollywood Bowl, Griffith Observatory, Greek Theatre), Rebuild LA wildfire recovery	Gehry Partners (Beckmen YOLA Center, seismic retrofit of mid-century bank — SEAOSC award)	Wildfire rebuild = short-term lane Miyamoto has captured. Civic landmarks (Hollywood Bowl) = a brand moat KOR lacks. Soft-story volume (commoditized). KOR’s differentiation vs Miyamoto: PBSO depth on larger NDC buildings and ASCE-41 analytical capability. [C — Miyamoto website]

Firm	Scale	LA strongholds	Confirmed architect/developer relationships	KOR strategic read
Holmes (Holmes US) — <i>NOT on original firm list; critical addition</i>	Multi-office US; LA + Seattle + Portland + SF	LA mass timber SE dominant — 85+ US mass timber buildings; 42XX Marina del Rey = LA's largest mass timber project (151,000 SF CLT/glulam, first LADBS mass-timber permits issued; opened Sept 2024)	RIOS (42XX confirmed — and RIOS is Gensler's LA mixed-use sub-brand equivalent for creative/lifestyle)	The LA mass timber incumbent KOR must know about. If KOR pursues mass timber in LA, Holmes is the displacement target. The 42XX / RIOS relationship is the anchor. KOR's BC CLT experience (multiple BC mass timber projects) is a real credential — but Holmes has the LADBS firstmover advantage and the RIOS relationship. Target: mass timber residential architects NOT yet locked to Holmes (KTGY, TSM, boutique residential). [C — Holmes website; RIOS website]
Structural Focus — <i>not on original list</i>	DTLA boutique	Seismic retrofit, historic preservation; “hundreds of existing buildings” + nearly two dozen National Register properties retrofitted	LA Conservancy-listed	Boutique NDC + historic competitor in KOR's lane. Less scale; potential teaming partner on complex NDC/historic projects. [U — limited web presence; SE firms agent]
MHP Structural Engineers	~40–50 staff, Long Beach HQ; ENR California Top 100	K-12 + community college (dominant), senior housing, civic; minimal market-rate MF	Sunrise Senior Living (50+ facilities CA/AZ/NV/UT — major repeat client)	Minimal competitive overlap with KOR. Education-dominant; no DTLA office. [C — MHP website]

2.4 Displacement Map by Segment

LA Segment	Incumbent SE(s)	KOR contest rating	Entry tactic
Concrete high-rise >15 story	Saiful Bouquet, TT, Arup, Englekirk/WSP	Avoid	Not KOR's lane — fee + track record gap
Concrete high-rise 8–15 story (dev-MF)	Englekirk/WSP, DCI, LFA	Medium	Boutique responsiveness + PBSO + Vancouver developer channel
Podium MF / 5-over-2 Type III/V	LFA, Englekirk/WSP, T&S Structural, boutiques	High	KOR's sweet spot; architect-first via KFA/Steinberg Hart/KTGY
Woodframe 4–6 story (Type V)	Fragmented (no dominant firm)	High	Dedicated CA woodframe team; SB 79 demand surge entry
Mass timber (Type IV)	Holmes (dominant)	Medium-High	KOR BC timber depth; target architects NOT yet locked to Holmes
Hospitality	Saiful Bouquet, KPFF	Low-Medium	Follow architect relationship; defer
Adaptive reuse / office-to-residential	LFA, SGH, Structural Focus, Miyamoto	Medium	KOR seismic + heritage pedigree; DTLA conversion pipeline (Jamison Properties target)

LA Segment	Incumbent SE(s)	KOR contest rating	Entry tactic
NDC seismic retrofit (owner-direct)	Degenkolb, SGH, LFA, Structural Focus, ZFA	High	Primary owner-direct lane; Phase 1 ASCE-41 feasibility product; file LADBS records request
Wildfire rebuild (Palisades/Eaton)	Miyamoto (Rebuild LA program), others	Medium	3–5 year demand runway; requires local LA presence to compete; medium-term
Soft-story (enforcement tail)	Optimum Seismic (design-build), boutiques	Low	Commoditized; skip as primary; use as LADBS relationship-builder only
Life science new-build	KPFF, TT, Saiful Bouquet	Avoid	No lab-space track record; market in oversupply
K-12 / HCAI hospitals	JAMA, KPFF, Degenkolb, Saiful Bouquet	Avoid	DSA/HCAI gate + track record gap
Civic/public	JAMA, KPFF	Avoid	No LA public track record; Judicial Council IDIQ = the one exception

3. Architect-Primes That Drive SE Selection

3.1 Confirmed Architect → SE Pairings (primary intelligence)

Architect	Confirmed SE partner	Project evidence	Open seat?
Gensler LA	Saiful Bouquet (luxury high-rise/hotel)	AC+Moxy Hotels \$250M DTLA [C]; Metropolis I 39-story [C]	Locked on trophy/hotel tier
Gensler LA	Englekirk/WSP (adaptive reuse/office)	Google Westside Pavilion (Hudson Pacific) [C]	Possibly soft on future adaptive reuse
Gehry Partners	DCI (high-rise residential)	The Grand LA, Related, 46-story [C]	Locked
Gehry Partners	Miyamoto (seismic retrofit)	Beckmen YOLA Center [C]	Separate lane from Gehry new construction
AC Martin	Thornton Tomasetti (trophy/supertall)	Wilshire Grand (legacy) [C]	Old; TT and AC Martin may not be active
AC Martin	[Open — no confirmed SE on Times Mirror Square]	Times Mirror 37+53-story, 1,127u [C — AC Martin is AOR]	OPEN — high priority target
TCA Architects	DCI (modular/mixed-use)	6th Street Place modular 2023 [C]	Locked for modular; other projects open
TCA Architects	Englekirk/WSP (podium residential)	Jefferson Inglewood, 8-story, 222u [C]	Post-WSP loosening possible
KTGY	JAMA (high-rise/adaptive reuse)	Upcycle Tower (concept, DTLA) [C]	Locked for Upcycle; other KTGY LA projects open
Lorcan O’Herlihy Architects (LOHA)	Labib Funk	1500 Granville, UCLA residential, AIA LA award 2022 [C]	Probably locked; monitor for LOHA’s next project
Olson Kundig	DCI	8899 Beverly, 9-story luxury 40u, AIA LA 2023 [C]	Probably locked
RIOS	Holmes	42XX Marina del Rey, mass timber, 151,000 SF [C]	Locked on mass timber
Omgivning	SGH	Lane Building NDC retrofit, SEAOSC award [C]	Probably locked

Architect	Confirmed SE partner	Project evidence	Open seat?
KFA (Killefer Flammang)	Brandow & Johnston	Strubb Hall historic/seismic (2023, LABCA award) [C]	Locked for historic/seismic work; Fox Hills is open
Solomon Cordwell Buenz	[SE not confirmed for Carmel/La Cienega]	1050 La Cienega 43-story, 532u [C — SCB architect]	Likely KPFF (SCB's default per national pattern) [P]

3.2 Architects by Priority for KOR Pursuit

Priority	Architect	Sectors	Scale	SE status	Action
1	KFA (Killefer Flammang)	Affordable, historic, mixed-use, adaptive reuse	Mid-size LA boutique	Open on Fox Hills 5757 Uplander (1,077u, Link Logistics) — no SE named [C]	Dual outreach: KFA principals + Link Logistics; 6–12 month window
2	AC Martin	Developer high-rise, civic, adaptive reuse	Large; LA institution	Times Mirror Square SE unconfirmed — biggest open high-rise in DTLA [P]	Reach AC Martin via Jim's LA network; position for Times Mirror or next developer commission
3	Withee Malcolm Architects	Mid-rise developer MF	Mid-size	Englekirk was the default; post-WSP = loosened [C]	"We're the boutique Englekirk used to be" pitch; cold outreach 2026
4	KTGY	Multifamily, mixed-use, senior, affordable	Very large (400+ post-GDA acq.)	JAMA on Upcycle; other LA projects open	Keith McCloskey; position for non-Upcycle KTGY LA projects
5	TCA Architects	High-density MF, mixed-use, hospitality	Very large; 20,000+ units in development	DCI (modular), Englekirk/WSP (podium) — rotating	Irwin Yau; target non-modular non-Englekirk TCA LA projects
6	Steinberg Hart	Mixed-use residential, high-rise, institutional	118-person firm; LA + multiple offices	[UNVERIFIED]	LADBS plan-check → pursue if SE seat open
7	Togawa Smith Martin (TSM)	LA multifamily specialist	Mid-size LA	WREN South Park (\$144M, 362u, first Type III double-podium in LA) — SE not named	Monitor WREN and next TSM project; run permit check
8	Johnson Fain / Nadel / Anonymous Architects	Century City / mixed-use / DTLA adaptive reuse	Various	[UNVERIFIED]	Research pass before cold outreach

4. Demand Side — Developers & Public Owners

4.1 Most Active LA Private Developers (2025–2026)

Developer	Pipeline / scale	Architect(s)	SE relationship	KOR angle
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Developer	Pipeline / scale	Architect(s)	SE relationship	KOR angle
Onni Group (Vancouver → DTLA)	Largest active DTLA developer. 1000 S. Hill (54-story, near complete); Times Mirror 37+53-story 1,127u (planned); Arts District (approved June 2026).	Arcadis/Dikeakos on 1000 S. Hill; AC Martin on Times Mirror	Glotman Simpson (1000 S. Hill and prior Onni DTLA projects) — KOR has prior dormant Onni LA work (Deltek)	#1 KOR leverage point. Vancouver tie + prior KOR Onni work = the re-engagement call happens in Vancouver, not in LA. Frame: “Glotman is capacity-locked building Senakw + Brentwood through the 2030s. We’re your Vancouver SE with bandwidth for your next project.” Times Mirror = the target if Glotman is not already signed. [C — Urbanize LA; prior research]
Carmel Partners	Major high-rise + MF developer. 1050 La Cienega (43-story, SCB architect); 520 Mateo Arts District (35-story); Cumulus District (910u); Linea (595u) + Sawtelle projects + Long Beach	Solomon Cordwell Buenz (1050 La Cienega)	Englekirk pre-WSP; SCB default likely KPFF	Post-Englekirk/WSP displacement target. William Cipes (wcipes@carmelpartners.com). 2026 is peak window. [C — The Real Deal; prior research]
Related California	Premium developer MF + mixed-use; The Grand LA (DCI/Gehry completed 2022)	DCI Engineers (The Grand)	DCI (The Grand, completed)	Geoff Canori (gcanori@related.com). Post-Englekirk loosening — Related’s next project after The Grand is the target. [C — prior research]
Mack Urban / AECOM Capital	South Park DTLA: \$1.2B, 6 buildings, 2,000+ units; WREN (362 units, \$144M, first Type III double-podium in LA — architect TSM)	TSM (WREN)	SE not confirmed on WREN	Monitor for Mack Urban’s Phase 2+ South Park projects. [C — SE firms research agent]
Intergulf Development	Smaller volume; live KOR client in LA (495 Hartford) and SD	Various	KOR (495 Hartford, woodframe)	Active KOR client. Expand: what is Intergulf’s next LA acquisition? Canadian repeat-developer pattern. [C — Deltek]
Link Logistics Real Estate	Logistics/industrial → residential. Fox Hills 5757 Uplander (1,077u, 3x 7-story, entitled Nov 2025; construction Q1 2027 earliest)	KFA	SE unconfirmed	The one verified open-seat developer in LA. SE selection window = 6–12 months. [C — WestsideToday; KFA website]
Cityview	#1 most-active LA multifamily developer for 6 consecutive years. Active pipeline includes 6136 Manchester (489 units, AC Martin AOR , groundbreak 2026) and multiple concurrent projects	AC Martin (every Cityview project)	Labib Funk + Associates (LF+A) is the entrenched Cityview SE incumbent — confirmed across multiple Cityview projects [C — architect/dev agent]	Enter via Cityview’s development team directly, not through AC Martin (Cityview selects SE before architect engagement). LF+A hold is real. Target Cityview’s <i>next</i> project before LF+A re-locks. [C]

Developer	Pipeline / scale	Architect(s)	SE relationship	KOR angle
Hackman Capital Partners	Television City \$1.25B — ~980,000 SF TV/studio campus adaptive reuse + residential; approved January 2025	Adamson Associates (AOR)	SE not confirmed — no incumbent named in research	High-value open SE opportunity. Television City is the largest entertainment/mixed-use adaptive reuse in LA right now. Structural scope = complex existing concrete/steel TV-production facility + new residential above/adjacent. Reach Hackman + Adamson Associates before SE is locked. [C — architect/dev agent]
Jamison Properties	DTLA office-to-residential conversions (active AB 2011 pipeline)	Various	Englekirk pre-WSP	Glen Lee (glee@jamisongroup.com). Adaptive reuse + seismic assessment = KOR's skill. [C — prior research]
Greenland Group	Metropolis (Gensler/Saiful Bouquet, 39-story + hotel); major DTLA presence	Gensler	Saiful Bouquet	Locked on Metropolis. Monitor for next Greenland LA project. [C — Saiful Bouquet website]
Mitsui Fudosan America	Figueroa Eight (Englekirk/WSP, 41-story, DTLA)	[architect not confirmed]	Englekirk/WSP	Post-WSP, Mitsui Fudosan's loyalty to the "Englekirk" brand vs the WSP reality is worth probing. Contact: Stanislav Morkun (smorkun@mfra.com).
Hudson Pacific Properties	Google Westside Pavilion (creative office adaptive reuse, Gensler/Englekirk/WSP)	Gensler	Englekirk/WSP	Locked on Westside Pavilion. Monitor next Hudson Pacific LA adaptive reuse. [C — DCI; Englekirk]

4.2 Public Owners & Capital Programs

Owner	Program	SE opportunity
City of LA (LADBS NDC Unit)	Administers the NDC ordinance; issues Orders to Comply	LADBS records request = the sourcing step for the owner-direct NDC lane. Contact: ladbs.nonductileconcrete@lacity.org / (213) 978-4475. [C — LADBS]
LA Metro	10,000 homes by 2031 via Joint Development; District NoHo (largest Metro JD ever); 4 rail + 3 BRT lines opening by 2028	Transit-adjacent residential JD = SE appointment through developer/architect team. Monitor Metro residential RFPs; SB 79 transit-band housing multiplies this pipeline. [C — Metro.net]
LAUSD	\$7B Measure RR + new \$9B bond (approved Nov 2024); earthquake upgrades for hundreds of buildings	DSA Field Act gate blocks KOR until 3+ school projects built. Watch-list only. [C]
Judicial Council of CA	Courthouse IDIQ — next cycle ~2026–27; no DSA gate	The one accessible public lane for KOR — no school/hospital track record required. [C — prior CA research]
UCLA / UC System	~\$608M active UCLA capital; seismic improvement projects (\$100M combined Mid-Wilshire + Wooden Center)	Through UCLA preferred-vendor lists; not KOR's entry target at this stage. [C — UCLA Capital Programs]

5. KOR Position & Strategy

5.1 Honest KOR LA Position

Dimension	Reality
Active LA projects	2 (495 Hartford/Intergulf; 674 Catalina/Square Nine)
Historical LA work	~10 projects in Deltek; Onni prior work (dormant); City Century/Vara = design-phase only, never built (drop as credential)
Verified warm relationships	Intergulf (live client); Onni (Vancouver tie + prior LA work, dormant); Glotman holds current Onni DTLA SE seats
Licensure	John Markulin PE/SE (CA) — KOR can stamp all core MF/mixed-use today
LA brand/community presence	Near-zero — no SEAOSC membership, no LATBSDC presentations, no published LA seismic work
Strategic position	Near-greenfield; a 2027+ patient build — not near-term revenue (unlike SD)

5.2 Where-to-Play — Priority Segments

Priority	Segment	Why KOR wins here	2026 timing signal
1	NDC Seismic Retrofit (owner-direct)	No architect gate; ASCE-41/PBSD-heavy (filters commodity competition); \$100–400K fees/building; ~1,400+ buildings remaining; 2028 plan-deadline creates urgency. KOR's PBSO + Markulin CA SE = genuine fit. No BC-seismic pure-SE firm owns this niche.	Active now — 2028 Year-10 plan deadline is 2 years away; building owners without SE engaged must hire now
2	Woodframe/Podium MF (5–15 story, via architects)	SB 79 (July 2026) = 85-ft by-right transit band = structural demand surge; KOR dedicated woodframe team is rare in SoCal; Fox Hills 1,077u is one confirmed open seat; market fragmented (no dominant firm)	Fox Hills SE selection window = 6–12 months; SB 79 pipeline starts mid-2026
3	Onni DTLA re-engagement (Vancouver developer)	KOR has prior Onni LA work (dormant); Onni is the largest active DTLA developer; Glotman is capacity-locked; the entry is through Vancouver, not a cold LA call	Times Mirror Square groundbreaking = trigger; Arts District approval (June 2026) = a second target
4	Englekirk/WSP boutique displacement (dev-MF)	Post-2021 WSP acquisition = client drift on developer-MF clients who chose Englekirk for boutique responsiveness; 2026 = peak displacement window before re-equilibration	Carmel Partners, Jamison, Related CA, Mitsui Fudosan, Withee Malcolm = 5 warm outreach targets
5	Wildfire Rebuild (Palisades/Eaton)	14,834 units, 3–5 year demand runway; \$150–300M SE fees; all require full 2022 CBC structural engineering	Requires local LA presence; medium-term opportunity (2026–2027 market entry build-toward)

5.3 How-to-Win — Specific Entry Mechanics

NDC retrofit entry:

1. File LADBS records request for the NDC covered-buildings list (not a clean bulk download; LADBS is still identifying covered buildings): (213) 978-4475 / ladbs.nonductileconcrete@lacity.org. Use data.lacity.org pre-1977 concrete permit filter as proxy in the interim.
2. Develop a **\$15–50K Phase 1 ASCE-41 Tier 1/2 feasibility study product** — owner gets a compliance path document; KOR earns the Year-10 design contract.
3. Differentiate vs Degenkolb (the #1 NDC incumbent): Degenkolb is embedded in city programs and institutional. KOR's pitch to mid-market private building owners: "independent, principal-led SE without city-program overhead — you get the same PBSO depth at a boutique fee."
4. Differentiate vs SGH (technical leader in NDC): SGH is a forensics/enclosure firm that does structural as a specialty. KOR is a pure SE firm with PBSO history.

Fox Hills / KFA architect entry:

1. Reach **Link Logistics Real Estate** (logistics developer, WA-HQ; identify LA development contact). Frame as "we're KOR, we've built 40+ seismic residential towers in Vancouver; this is our structural typology."
2. Simultaneously engage **KFA Architecture** principals. KFA focuses on affordable housing and historic preservation — KOR's seismic pedigree in a seismically challenging Culver City site (Fox Hills near Inglewood/LAX ground motion zone) is directly relevant.
3. Note: Brandow & Johnston has an existing KFA relationship (Strubb Hall); the Fox Hills project is a different typology (new residential vs. historic), so the relationship is not locked.

Onni re-engagement:

- KOR leadership meeting in Vancouver with Onni Vancouver development principals before any LA call. Frame: "We are your Vancouver SE with California licensure and two active LA projects. Glotman is building Senakw + Brentwood through 2030+. We have bandwidth for Times Mirror / Arts District."
- The Glotman displacement narrative applies: Glotman holds current Onni DTLA work but is capacity-stretched and their SE appointments were made pre-pandemic. KOR's entry is the *next* Onni project, not a mid-project displacement.

Community presence (2026–27 foundation investment):

- **SEAOSC membership** — the professional home of every LA SE, architect, and developer. Zero KOR presence today. This is the single biggest reputational gap.
- **LATBSDC (LA Tall Buildings Structural Design Council)** — where boutique seismic engineers build architect and developer trust. NYA, Saiful Bouquet, Degenkolb, Englekirk principals are regulars. KOR's PBSO heritage is compelling here.
- **1–2 SEAOSC presentations** on Vancouver high-importance seismic performance or ASCE-41 NDC methodology — positions KOR as the boutique seismic expert in the room.

5.4 Prioritized Target Shortlist

#	Target	Type	Entry move	Contact	Window
1	LADBS NDC covered-buildings list	Market sourcing	File records request; develop Phase 1 product	ladbs.nonductileconcrete@lacity.org / (213) 978-4475	Now
2	Link Logistics / KFA — Fox Hills 5757 Uplander (1,077u)	Open SE seat	Dual outreach — architect + developer	KFA LA principals; Link Logistics LA development contact [identify]	6–12 months
3	Onni Group — Times Mirror Square + Arts District	Warm developer re-engagement	Vancouver principals meeting; Onni HQ	Onni Vancouver development leadership [via Vancouver BD contacts]	Pre-groundbreaking
4	AC Martin — Times Mirror Square SE (open)	High-rise architect outreach	Jim's LA network → Michael Chang; Times Mirror SE appears unconfirmed	Michael Chang, AC Martin Managing Principal	Immediate; before SE lock
5	Carmel Partners (William Cipes)	Englekirk/WSP displacement	Boutique-seismic alternative pitch; next LA project	wcipes@carmelpartners.com	2026 (peak window)

#	Target	Type	Entry move	Contact	Window
6	Withee Malcolm Architects	Englekirk/WSP architect-side displacement	"We're the boutique Englekirk was before WSP"	[contact TBD]	2026
7	Jamison Properties (Glen Lee)	DTLA adaptive reuse	Seismic assessment of existing concrete buildings = KOR niche	glee@jamisongroup.com	Active now
8	Intergulf LA forward pipeline	Existing client expansion	Ask: what is Intergulf's next LA acquisition?	Intergulf Vancouver contacts (via Hartford relationship)	Ongoing
9	Hackman Capital / Adamson Associates — Television City (\$1.25B, 980K SF)	Major adaptive reuse SE seat	Reach Hackman Capital development team + Adamson Associates; SE unconfirmed	Hackman Capital LA principals; Adamson Associates [identify]	Immediate — approved Jan 2025, SE selection in progress
10	SEAOSC / LATBSDC membership + presentation	Brand/community foundation	Join SEAOSC; propose LATBSDC talk on PBSO/ASCE-41 or BC seismic performance	seaosc.org	2026–27
10	Mitsui Fudosan (Stanislav Morkun)	Post-Englekirk developer	Next project after Figueroa Eight	smorkun@mfra.com	Monitor Figueroa Eight completion; then approach
11	Related California (Geoff Canori)	Post-Englekirk developer	Next project after The Grand	gcanori@related.com	Monitor; 2026 outreach
12	Holmes displacement — KTG / TSM mass timber	Mass timber architect-side entry	Position for KTG/TSM mass timber residential (not yet locked to Holmes)	Keith McCloskey (KTG); TSM principals	Project-dependent

5.5 Hard Stops — What KOR Does NOT Chase in LA

Target	Reason
LAUSD / K-12	DSA Field Act gate (3+ CA school projects required)
HCAI hospital seismic	Degenkolb/Rutherford+Chekene moat + HCAI track record required
UC/Caltech campus new-build	KPFF/Saiful Bouquet lock; no UC track record
Soft-story enforcement tail	Commoditized at \$5–15K; contractor-bundled (Optimum Seismic) competition; structural break-even
Life science new-build	Market in oversupply; no lab SE track record
One Beverly Hills / Metropolis tier	Saiful Bouquet's turf; not in KOR's conversation until LA brand is established
Metro civil infrastructure	Civil/transit; not structural buildings work

6. Additional LA targets to pursue

Developers and architects worth opening, with the reason each is in play:

Firm	Type	Why flag
Link Logistics Real Estate	Developer	Fox Hills 1,077u — open SE seat; critical near-term target
Cityview	Developer	Active LA MF developer; AC Martin architect relationship
Carmel Partners	Developer	Major LA high-rise + MF; Englekirk-loosened account
Jamison Properties	Developer	DTLA office-to-residential; Englekirk-loosened; SE resets on each conversion
Related California	Developer	Premium MF; Englekirk-loosened (The Grand is closed; next project is the target)
Greenland Group	Developer	Metropolis DTLA (Gensler/Saiful Bouquet); monitor for next LA project
Hackman Capital Partners	Developer	Television City \$1.25B adaptive reuse (Adamson AOR); SE unconfirmed; high-value open seat
Mack Urban / AECOM Capital	Developer	South Park \$1.2B DTLA; WREN = first Type III double-podium in LA
Mitsui Fudosan America	Developer	Figueroa Eight 41-story (Englekirk/WSP); contact = Stanislav Morkun
TCA Architects	Architect	20,000+ units in dev.; DCI (modular) + Englekirk/WSP (podium) — SE rotating
KFA (Killefer Flammang)	Architect	Confirmed open Fox Hills seat; B&J historic relationship (separate lane)
Steinberg Hart	Architect	Mid-large MF; SE gap
Withee Malcolm Architects	Architect	Post-Englekirk/WSP displacement target; SE seat loosened
Togawa Smith Martin (TSM)	Architect	LA MF specialist; WREN South Park (SE unconfirmed)
Lorcan O’Herlihy Architects (LOHA)	Architect	LFA relationship; monitor for LOHA’s next project
Omgivning	Architect	DTLA adaptive reuse; SGH relationship (Lane Building) — SE seat on next Omgivning project
Holmes (Holmes US)	SE Competitor	LA mass timber dominant; 42XX RIOS partnership confirmed
Structural Focus	SE Competitor	DTLA boutique; NDC + National Register historic properties
T&S Structural Engineers	SE Competitor	LA woodframe MF specialist since 1994
ZFA Structural	SE Competitor	Self-described NDC specialist; LA active
B&J HBK (Brandow & Johnston)	SE Competitor	Now HBK-owned; historic/seismic + USC/KFA relationships
Optimum Seismic	SE+Contractor competitor	Design-build soft-story; 3,500 buildings SoCal; not a pure-SE competitor but owns the soft-story volume market

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Brief compiled 2026-06-26. Research agent: four parallel web-research sub-agents (market segments, SE firms, architect primes/developers, seismic retrofit) + direct web searches. Confidence-tagged throughout: [C] Confirmed against primary source / [P] Probable (inferred from verified context) / [U] Unverified (search-derived, verify before acting). No firms, projects, or relationships fabricated. For DOCX conversion: run tools/Format-BdDocx.ps1 against this file.